



CHECK-IN

KUISC - WINDOWS FORENSICS
WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 30 AT 6:00PM



<https://cglink.me/2rx/c377841928145157>



WINDOWS ACTIVE DIRECTORY

Windows Forensics: Meeting 5

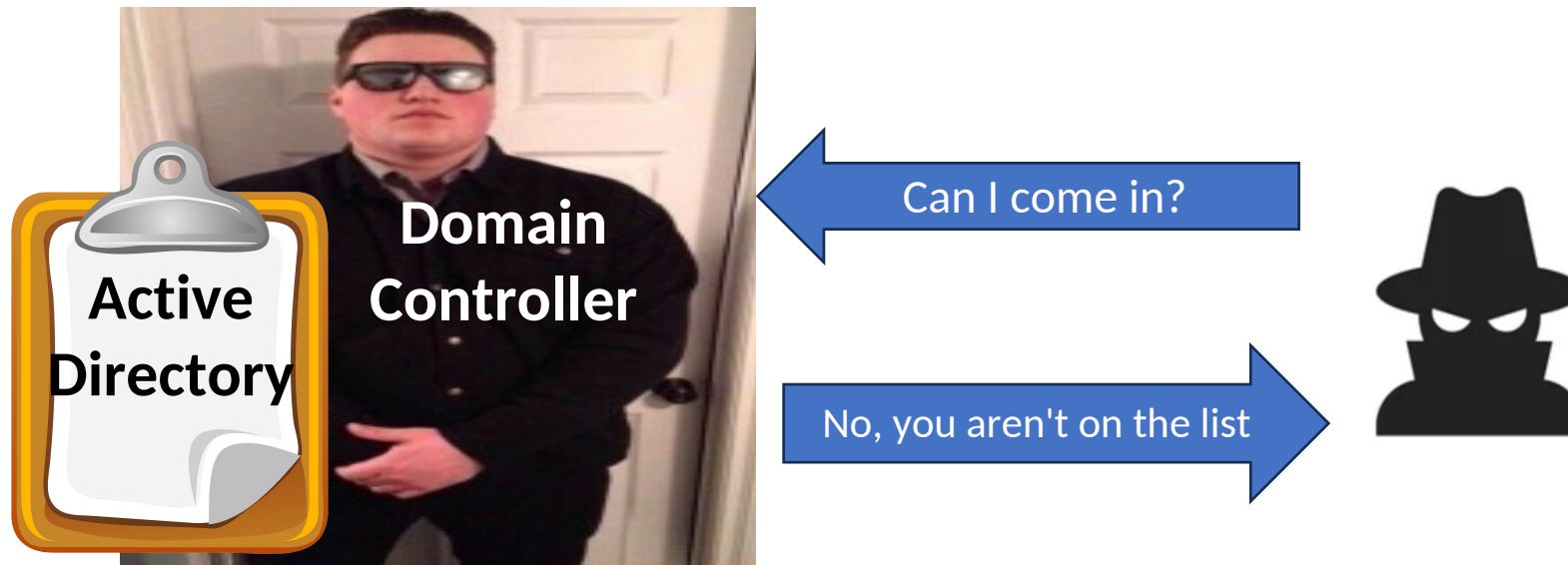
Why learn about Windows Active Directory?



- Most corporate networks use Windows AD.
- It controls what users can log in, what they can access, and what policies apply to every machine.
- Domain Controller (the machine that handles the AD) needs to be fully protected. Compromise the Domain Controller, and you can have full access to the machines in that domain.

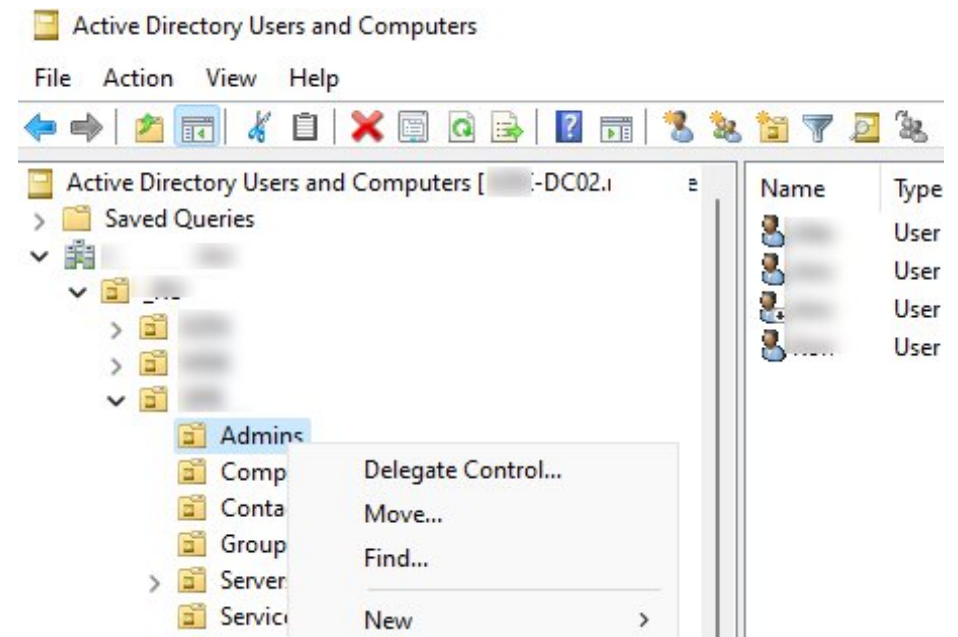
What is Active Directory?

- Central database of users, groups, computers, and policies
- Runs on a Windows Server called the Domain Controller (DC)
- Handles authentication (who are you?) and authorization (what can you do?)

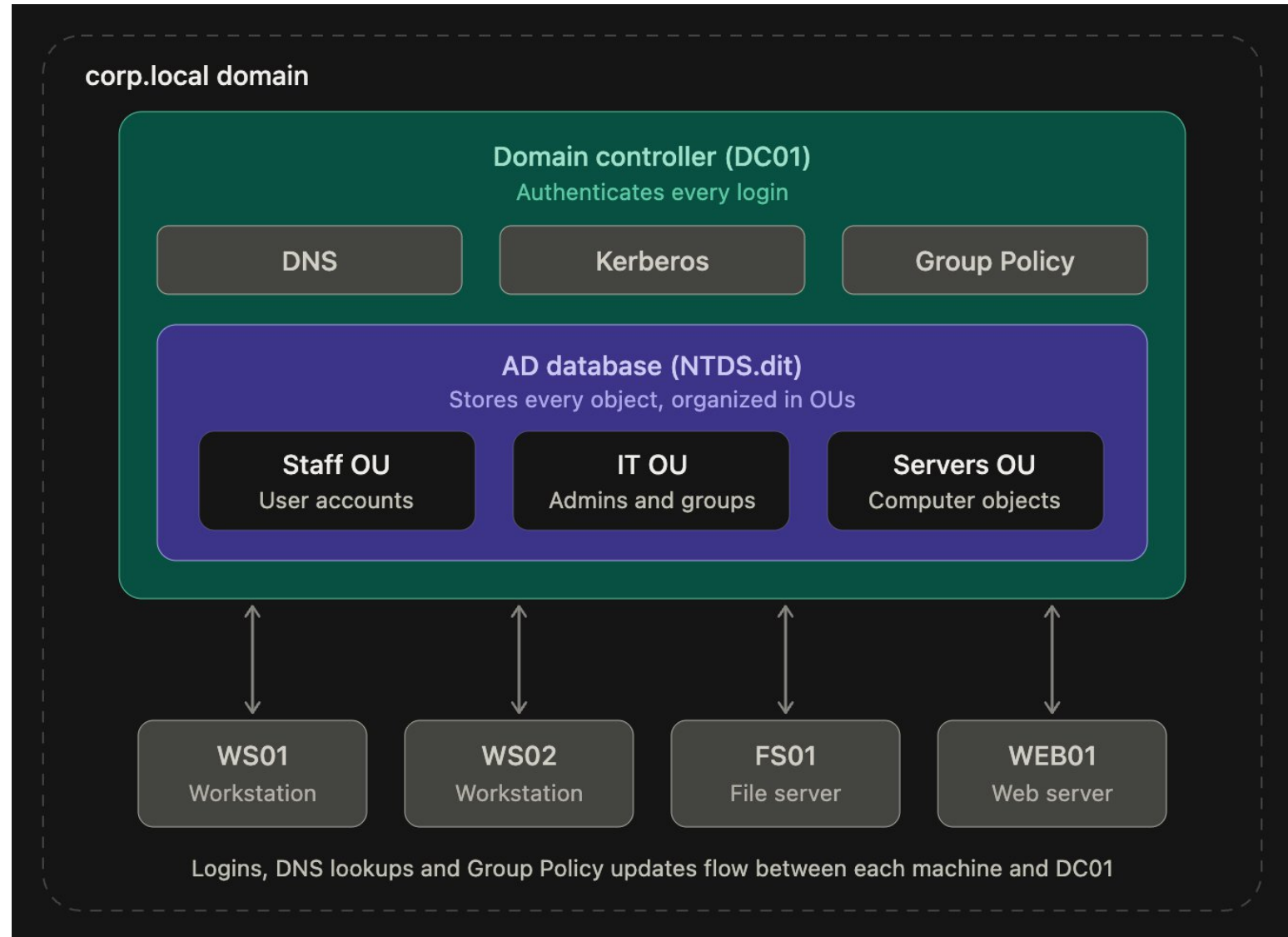


Important Definitions

- **Object** – Anything stored in the AD (users, groups, computers, policies)
- **Domain** – A group of network objects that share a database and set of policies
- **Domain Controller** – The server that hosts the AD and handles logins
- **Organizational Unit (OU)** – Folder for organizing objects.

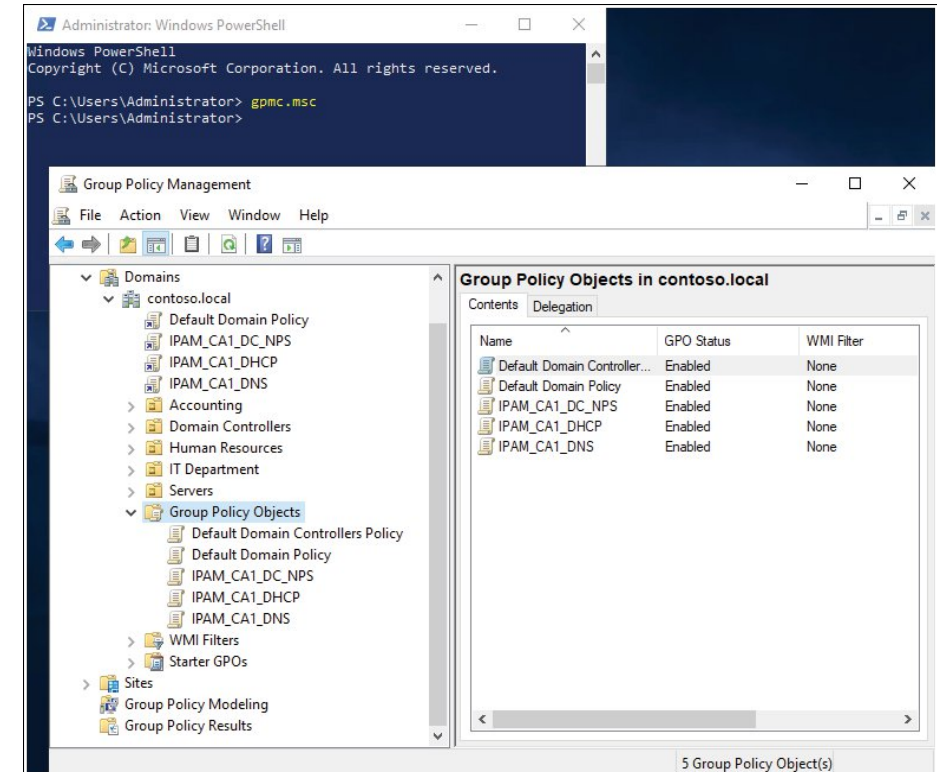


Domain



What is Group Policy?

- Management feature that allows administrators to enforce policies across a group of users and machines
- Settings are bundled into Group Policy Objects (GPOs) and linked to a site, domain, or OU
- Important: Group policy takes precedent over local settings.





CHALLENGE TIME

Windows AD Admin and Forensics Challenge

Situation – Use the provided domain controller VM to solve the forensics challenges and complete the specified admin tasks

User: jhacker

Pass: jayhacker

First to complete the challenge gets a brownie!

